



APPLICATION DEVELOPMENT PRACTICES

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Customer Satisfaction



Director's Overview

- What is Customer Satisfaction?
- Kano Model (for assessing customer satisfaction)
- Why is this important to you?
- Stakeholders
- Additional customer satisfaction measures

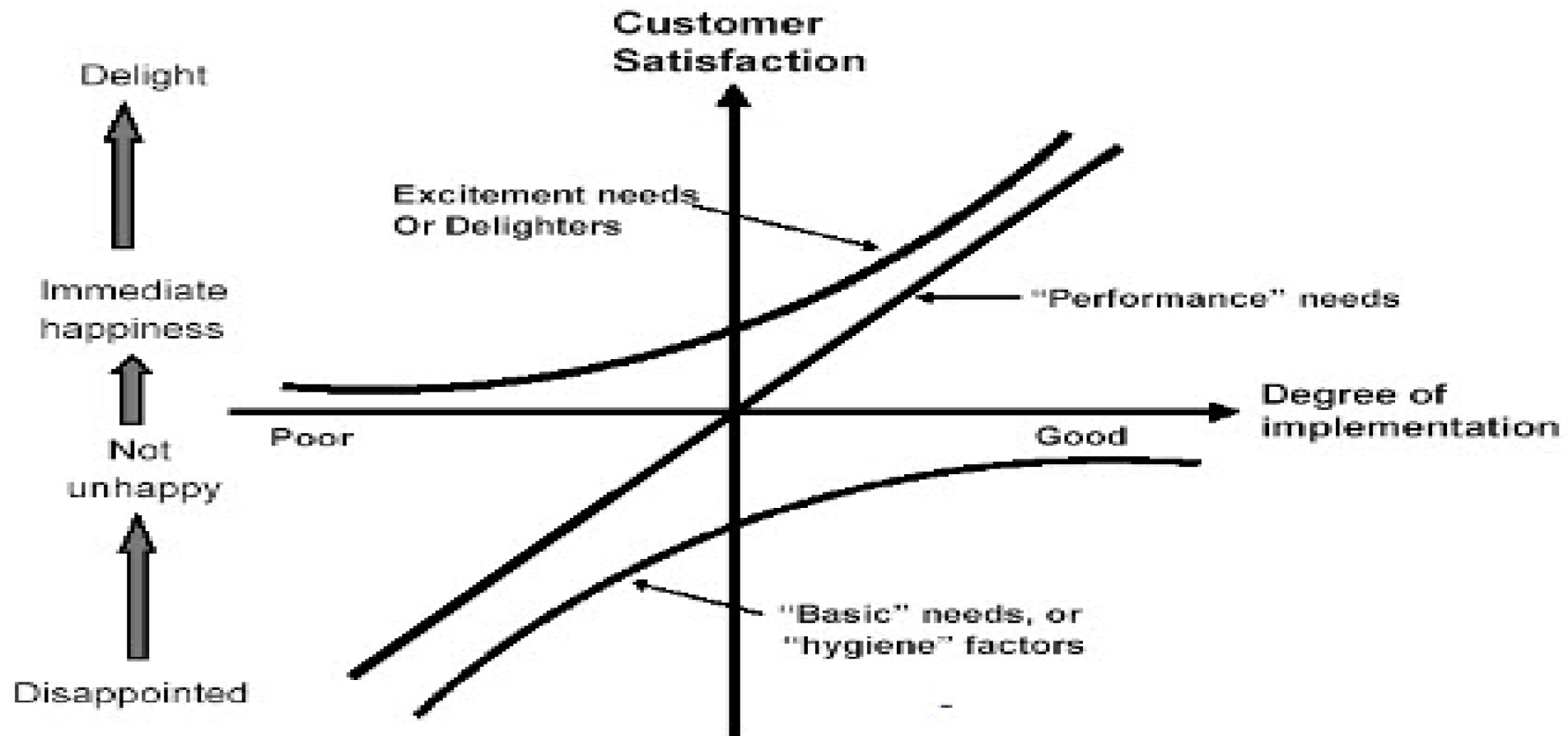


What is Customer Satisfaction?

- A measure of how products and services supplied by a company meet or surpass customer expectation
 - Because satisfaction is basically a psychological state, care should be taken in the effort of quantitative measurement
 - The usual measures of customer satisfaction involve a survey with a set of statements using a Likert scale
 - May want to consider using the Kano model
 - Invented by Noriaki Kano in the 1980's



Kano Model





Kano Analysis Technique

- Focuses on subjective measures
- Separates features into:
 - Exciters
 - Linear
 - Baseline



Exciters

- “I recently stayed in one that truly delighted me”
 - After putting my bags in the room, I went downstairs to exercise
 - Built into each treadmill was a small television I could control, which really thrilled me
 - I didn't have to watch the communal television just because someone had already tuned to those stations
 - But it did require headphones, which I hadn't brought. Then I noticed that the hotel gave away free headphones with disposable foam earpieces. Can you see why I was delighted?
 - After working out, I went back to my room. I was thirsty and noticed, again to my delight, that the bottle of water the hotel left in my room was free, not \$4 as in most hotels
 - An exciter is a feature that a user doesn't know he wants until he sees it
 - This hotel had done a wonderful job of providing features called "exciters" or "delighters"
- <http://www.stickyminds.com/sitewide.asp?Function=edetail&ObjectType=COL&ObjectId=9405>



Linear

- “The next category, linear, is for features that we can describe as “the more of the better”
- An example would be the size of my hotel room. I am generally more satisfied when a room is 500 square feet rather than 250 square feet
 - The more area there is in my hotel room, the better
- The presence and quantity of a linear feature correspond directly to a user’s satisfaction with the product
- Other examples of linear features are battery life on a cell phone, horsepower in a car, and the number of chocolate chips in a Chips Ahoy cookie”



Baseline

- “The final category is for features that are mandatory”
- If a product does not include all mandatory (or baseline) features, customers will be dissatisfied and will not buy the product
- My hotel provided a bed, a shower, a television, and so on
- It was also reasonably clean and secure
- I consider each of these factors to be a baseline feature for a hotel



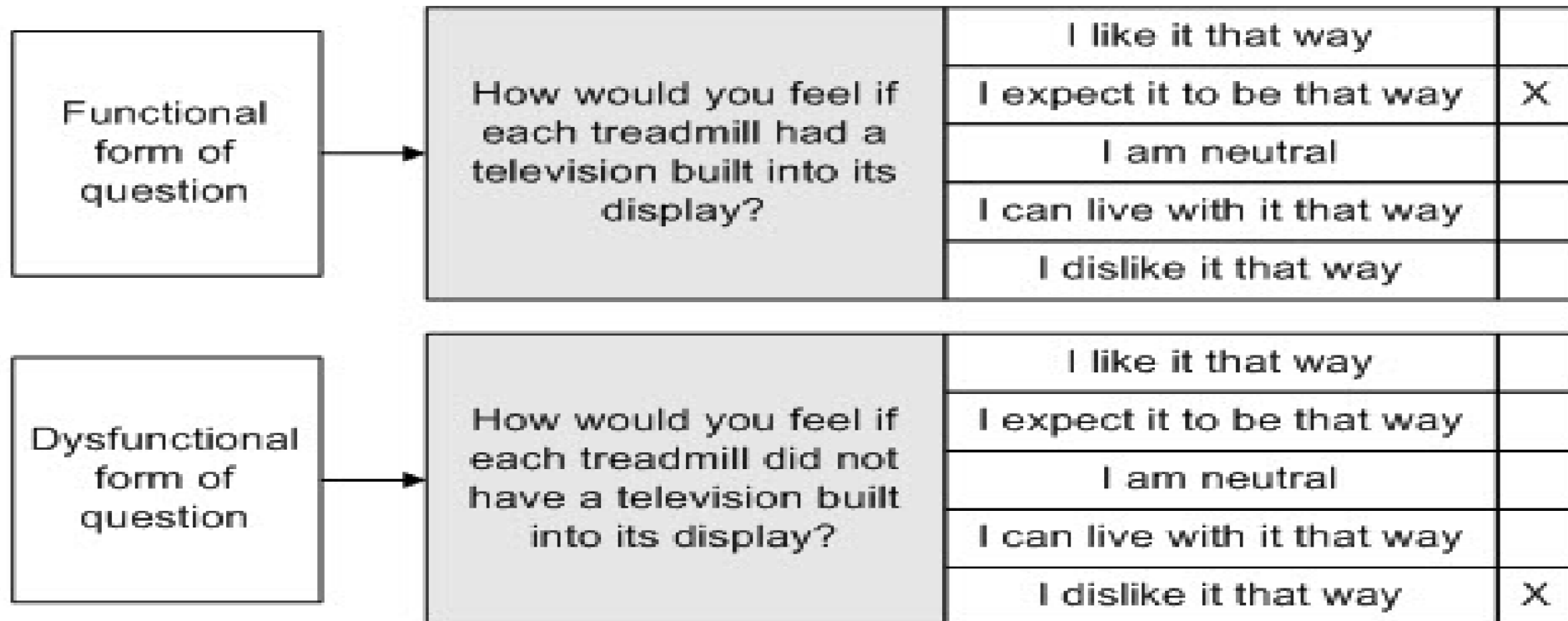
Kano Surveys

- The Kano analysis approach involves asking potential users sets of paired questions
- Each pair includes:
 - The *functional* question, which asks the user how she would feel if a feature were present
 - The *dysfunctional* question that asks the user how she'd feel if the feature were not present



Kano Survey Questions - Example

- See next slide for how to interpret





Kano Survey Example

- Based on my response, each treadmill having its own tv is mandatory

Customer Requirements		Dysfunctional Question				
		Like	Expect	Neutral	Live with	Dislike
Functional Question	Like	Q	E	E	E	L
	Expect	R	I	I	I	M
	Neutral	R	I	I	I	M
	Live with	R	I	I	I	M
	Dislike	R	R	R	R	Q

M Mandatory

L Linear

E Exciter

R Reverse

Q Questionable

I Indifferent



Issues with Kano Approach

- Kano approach focuses on user satisfaction
 - When quality is subjective
- Quality can also be objective
 - Conformance to requirements



Why is this Important?

- “The best products include:
 - All baseline features (they have to)
 - An appropriate mix of linear features and excitors
- Remember that linear features have a linear effect on customer satisfaction
 - The more of them, the better
 - However, since time is scarce and often insufficient for everything desired in most products, we often cannot deliver all linear features
- Even so, leaving room for some excitors does wonders for customer satisfaction
- Users will often pay a premium for a product with the right mix of delighters”



Why is this Important to You?

- So you understand that customer satisfaction is both subjective and objective
 - Customers can be annoyingly contradictory and complex with their responses. Example:
 - I won't drink anything with too much sugar in it
 - I love drinking milk (which has lots of sugar in it)
- When talking with customers you can ask questions about features in pairs to understand
 - Functional
 - Dysfunctional



Why is this Important to You?

- If you are asked to be part of a CCB you can use the Kano analysis technique to help determine product priorities
- If the customer seems dissatisfied with the product, you can suggest using the Kano analysis technique to your management



Who Are Your Customers?

- Customer
 - Is paying for the product
- User Community
 - Will be using the product
- Your Executive Management
 - Are paying you to keep the customer and user community happy
- The Project Team
 - Anyone who consumes your deliverables
 - What are you doing to make them successful?
- Others ...



Customer Satisfaction Dimensions

- Product Features
 - Does the customer end up with a good set of delighters, linear and baseline features?
- Product Quality
 - Are the customer's quality concerns understood (see Quality Characteristics in previous sections) and addressed?
 - Do all features work as expected?
 - Are the project's quality processes (see Is Quality an Accident in previous sections) working for everyone?
 - If not, change them



Customer Satisfaction Dimensions

- Value
 - Does the customer perceive that this project was worth the time, money and aggravation that it cost?
- Timeliness
 - Did the customer get the product or feature on time?
- Teamwork
 - Did the customer feel part of the team?



Customer Satisfaction Dimensions

- Front line Service Behaviors
 - Was the development team helpful and responsive to the customer without simply agreeing to everything?
 - Was the development team effective in communicating with the customer?
- Commitment to the Customer
 - Was the development team committed to doing everything it could to help the customer be successful with this project?



Customer Satisfaction Dimensions

- Innovation
 - Did the development team come up with new and innovative ideas to meet the customer's needs?
- Others ...



Communicating with Customers

- Understand customer expectations
 - Different types and levels of communication and interaction depending on needs and preferences
 - What communications would they like to receive?
 - What involvement would they like to have
- Set expectations
 - The process – how we will work together
 - What they should expect from you
 - What you expect from them
 - What will be communicated, how often, in what format and to whom



Attitude

- “There is no communication without rapport” – Theresa Blanding



What if There are Problems?

- If it's you:
 - Admit to the problem, learn from it and move forward
 - Don't try to hide it, you'll be perceived as not trustworthy
- If it is the customer:
 - Try to come up with a strategy for dealing with them that will solve your problem
 - Ask for help



What if There are Problems?

- If it just isn't working:
 - Talk with your customer privately
 - Be professional and respectful
 - Don't do all the talking - Listen to what they have to say
 - Try to come to a resolution that meets the customer's needs
 - You need the customer more than he needs you



Summary

- Customer satisfaction has two measures
 - Objective
 - Subjective
- Subjective measures are subject to bias
- Have a quality process and use it
 - If it doesn't work, change it
- Attitude goes a long way
- If it just isn't working out, consider what you would want to have happen if you were the customer